Builders Ready: Marketing Plan

Positioning, channels, calendar and the path to a known cost of acquisition

Builders Ready Ltd · Company no. 17551960

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The one-page version

Builders Ready is a finished, paying product with a near-free content engine already running. The job of marketing for the next two quarters is not growth for its own sake, it is to **learn the true cost to acquire a paying trade (CAC), get it comfortably under a third of lifetime value, and then pour budget into the one or two channels that hit that bar.** The budget is roughly £800 a month (from the director's loan, with about £200 of the monthly £1,000 going to business upkeep). That number cannot out-shout Tradify or Powered Now on paid ads, and it is not meant to. It buys data and amplifies what already works organically. The sharpest hook is Planning Radar: "Builders Ready finds you building jobs before they are advertised." Trades come first because trades pay; homeowners are brought in through the marketplace as a reason to subscribe, not through consumer ad spend.

Positioning

The UK-native app that runs the whole building job and brings you the work, priced by project, not per head.

The messaging hierarchy, lead with the win, not the admin:

1. **Win the work** (Planning Radar + the no-per-lead-fee marketplace). This is the differentiator no competitor has.
2. **Run the job** (quote on site, signed decisions, live client portal, the dispute killer).
3. **Get paid** (staged payments by card, bank or cash, straight to the builder).

Supporting proof points: built and live on iOS, Android and web; branded for each builder; sterling billing and UK data residency; one flat price for a team, not a price per seat; a flat £3 per card payment, never a percentage.

Tone: conversational, builder-to-builder, UK English, no corporate gloss. Speak to "you," lead with the builder's problem or win, and let the app be the how.

Audiences

- **Primary: the paying trade.** Sole traders and small firms (roughly 1 to 15 staff) doing domestic and light-commercial work: extensions, lofts, bathrooms, kitchens, renovations, and the trades around them. They feel the admin pain and they want more work. Every marketing pound chases this person.
- **Secondary, higher value: the contractor.** Firms running several jobs and a crew, the buyers for scheduling, subcontractor management and CIS, and the £149 tier. Reached later, through the same channels plus product depth.
- **Tertiary, not paid for directly: the homeowner.** Demand for the marketplace. Valuable only once an area has enough trades to answer jobs, so homeowner interest is used as a reason trades subscribe, not funded with consumer ad campaigns yet.

Five strategic principles

1. **Trades first, homeowners later.** Trades pay the subscriptions. Homeowner demand is a feature that sells subscriptions, not a market to buy.
2. **Concentrate geographically.** A budget spread across the UK is invisible. Focused on one or two regions it builds visible density: local reviews, word of mouth, marketplace liquidity, and Planning Radar actually having nearby jobs. Pick the area with the most existing users and own it before widening.
3. **Organic-led, paid-amplified.** The content engine is built and nearly free. Paid money amplifies what already works and retargets interest; it does not carry cold reach alone.
4. **One hook above all: Planning Radar.** It is sharper and more native than "job-management software," and no one else has it.
5. **Measure CAC against real LTV.** Aim for CAC payback inside three to four months and CAC under one third of lifetime value. Any channel that cannot hit that gets cut.

The funnel and where money helps

Stage	What is happening	Cheapest effective lever
Reach	Trades discover Builders Ready	Organic short video (free) + small paid prospecting tests
Interest	They click, watch, visit the site	Retargeting (cheap, high ROI) + the new site
Trial	They start the 14-day trial	Clear CTA, the Flash48 offer, frictionless onboarding
Paid	Trial converts to subscription	Email nurture + in-app nudges (free)
Retain / refer	They stay and tell mates	Referral incentive + a product they love (free, best ROI)

Paid budget earns the most at **Interest (retargeting)** and **Trial (high-intent search)**. Reach is fed organically.

Channels and budget

The starting monthly split of roughly £800. Rebalance every month: the lowest-CAC channel gets more, the worst gets cut.

Channel	£/mo	Why
Meta (Facebook / Instagram): retargeting + a small prospecting test	**£300**	Trades genuinely live in Facebook groups. Start with retargeting (cheap, converts), boost the best organic Reels rather than making ad-only creative, and run one small lookalike/interest test.
Google Search: tight, high-intent keywords	**£250**	Catch people already looking: "builder quoting app," "job management software for builders," "[competitor] alternative." Small keyword set, exact/phrase match, UK plus the focus region. Highest-intent trial quality.
Creator / content amplification	**£150**	Pay a trusted trade creator for an honest post or collaboration, or put spend behind the single best organic video each month. One credible builder saying "this finds me work" beats any ad.
Tools + experiments buffer	**£100**	Scheduling tool, the odd design asset, and a small budget to test one new thing a month (a trade newsletter sponsorship, a merchant leaflet, a local group promo).

What **not** to spend on yet: paid homeowner/consumer ads (premature until trade density exists), national brand awareness (the budget would vanish), expensive directory or trade-mag display ads (only if measurable), and new ad creative when a proven organic video can simply be boosted.

The content engine (the real engine, near-free)

The £800 amplifies this; it does not replace it. The founder already runs a short-video setup and an email list.

- **Cadence:** 3 to 5 short videos a week across TikTok, Instagram Reels and LinkedIn, each cut repurposed to all three (house style already defined).
- **Content pillars:** (1) Planning Radar wins ("your next job is already in the council's files"), (2) the quote-to-paid lifecycle (a branded quote the client signs from their inbox, straight into a project), (3) builder pain and relief (chasing invoices, admin, getting paid), (4) proof (real app screens, real numbers, before and after), (5) light / engagement (desk setup, day in the life, no pitch).
- **Email:** the prospect list is essentially free through the company's own verified domain. A regular, useful email (a feature, a tip, a Planning Radar example) keeps trials converting and lapsed prospects warm, with occasional offer emails (Flash48) used sparingly. Note: deliverability now depends on list hygiene more than authentication, so suppress long-term non-openers and keep mailing the engaged.
- **Blog / SEO:** low cost, slow burn, compounding. Target what trades search ("how to quote a job," "JCT contract for small builders," "finding building work"). The site's SEO foundations (sitemap, canonicals, structured data) are in place; the next gains are content and backlinks, not tags.
- **App Store Optimisation:** free and high-leverage. Title, keywords, screenshots and reviews drive organic installs; ask happy users for App Store and Play reviews.

Marketing calendar aligned to the roadmap

Tie each product milestone to a content and email beat, so launches do double duty.

Month	Product beat to market	Marketing focus
Nov 2026	New site + new dashboard; certification badges	Dashboard email (sent); video on Planning Radar + the office view; stand up pixel/tag + UTM tracking
Dec 2026	"Scheduling is coming" (team seats)	Month-1 paid tests in the focus region; tease the contractor features to lift interest
Jan 2027	Scheduling v1 live	Launch email + video series:

		crew diary and timesheets; push the £149 story
Feb 2027	Subcontractor management	Content for contractors; first paid creator collaboration; launch the referral incentive
Mar 2027	CIS help	"Stay on top of CIS" content, a strong search-intent and trust angle
Apr to May 2027	Xero / QuickBooks sync	"It fits your accountant now" campaign, aimed straight at the biggest switching objection

90-day rollout

Month 1, set up to measure. Confirm the founder dashboard is surfacing CAC inputs, trial starts, trial-to-paid and MRR (the scoreboard). Stand up conversion tracking: Meta Pixel, Google tag, and UTM tags on every link, so each signup is attributable. Launch small: Meta retargeting plus a tight Google Search campaign in the chosen focus region. Keep the organic video cadence and tag which posts drive site visits.

Month 2, find the winner. Read the numbers: which channel brings trials that convert and stick, and at what CAC. Double down on the best, cut the worst, test one creator collaboration, and start the email nurture for trials that did not convert.

Month 3, concentrate and prove. Put the majority of the budget behind the single best channel in the single best region. Launch a referral incentive (a free month for referrer and referee), the cheapest acquisition there is. Write up what CAC and LTV look like: the number that justifies a bigger budget or an investor conversation.

Metrics and targets

Track monthly from the founder dashboard plus the ad platforms:

- Spend per channel, cost per trial, and CAC (cost per paying trade).
- Trial starts, trial-to-paid conversion %, new MRR, churned MRR, net MRR growth.
- CAC payback (months of subscription to recover CAC): target under 3 to 4 months.
- LTV:CAC: target above 3:1, where LTV is approximately ARPU multiplied by gross margin multiplied by average months retained.

Until the dashboard gives real ARPU and churn, treat every channel as on probation and judge it on cost per converting trial.

The homeowner-acquisition gap

The marketplace is two-sided, and the plan deliberately does not pay to acquire homeowners yet. The risk is a cold start: homeowners who post jobs and get no answers churn, and trades who see no jobs lose interest. The mitigation is geographic concentration: build enough trade density in one region that homeowner demand there gets answered quickly, use that liquidity as a proof point in trade marketing ("real jobs near you, no per-lead fee"), and only widen to a second region once the first works. When the time comes to add homeowner demand deliberately, local and organic (community groups, local SEO, trade referrals passing homeowners in) will be cheaper than consumer paid ads.

Immediate next actions

1. Confirm the founder dashboard surfaces CAC, trial starts, trial-to-paid and MRR. Nothing here is measurable without it.
2. Pick the one focus region to concentrate on.
3. Set up pixel/tag plus UTM tracking before spending a penny on ads.
4. Launch the month-1 small Meta retargeting plus Google Search tests.
5. Keep the video cadence at 3 to 5 a week and tag what drives traffic.
6. Run list hygiene on the email list (suppress long-term non-openers) to lift inbox placement.

This plan is deliberately cheap to start and built to tell you quickly what works. The content engine does the heavy lifting; the budget buys reach and, more importantly, data. Revisit the allocation every month.